

Saturday, 20 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 26° 18°	BIRMINGHAM Heavy drizzle 24° 16°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 22° 17°	GLASGOW Rain 17° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The political landscape is buzzing after Labour's by-election win in Makerfield, putting renewed focus on Keir Starmer's leadership.

Andy Burnham not only held the seat but increased Labour's share of the vote. This success has sparked discussions about the Prime Minister's future and potential paths for Burnham.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

The Princess of Wales has shared a deeply personal essay, reflecting on her recent tour of Italy and the challenges of a digital world.

Kate's essay, written after her return to overseas visits following cancer treatment, encourages us to 'prioritise love'. New pictures from the tour have also been released.

ROYALS · UK
- 3

The jury in the high-profile sex abuse trial of former DUP leader Sir Jeffrey Donaldson has been sent home for the weekend.

Sir Jeffrey faces 18 charges, including one count of rape, all of which he denies. The trial is expected to resume next week.

CRIME · UK
- 4

Big changes could be coming to the housing market, with plans to end 'gazumping' and make sales agreements legally binding much sooner.

The proposed shake-up aims to streamline the house-buying process. Sellers would also be required to provide more detailed home information upfront.

PROPERTY · UK
- 5

Concerns are being raised over the UK's 'fragile' public finances, as government borrowing continues to rise significantly.

Official figures show the UK borrowed £23.3 billion in May, almost a third more than the same month last year. This highlights growing pressure on the national budget.

ECONOMY · UK

What's coming up

- 1 **Get ready for some glitz and glamour, as Kim Kardashian's hair stylist Chris Appleton is set to join the Strictly Come Dancing line-up!**
The British stylist is renowned for working with A-listers like Jennifer Lopez and Ariana Grande. He's sure to bring some serious style to the dancefloor this series.
ON AIR – Who do you think Chris Appleton will be partnered with, and what kind of routines do you expect?
TV · AUTUMN

- 2 **The highly anticipated Toy Story 5 has just been released, and while critics are split, many are praising its 'cautionary' message about technology.**
Tom Hanks, Tim Allen, and Joan Cusack all return to voice their beloved characters in the fifth instalment of the animated franchise. It's certainly got people talking!
ON AIR – Are you excited for Toy Story 5? What kind of cautionary message about technology do you think it might have?
FILM · NOW

- 3 **Singer Jack Savoretti is marking 20 years in music, reflecting on his journey and how a move to Oxfordshire has influenced his sound.**
He's openly discussed 'leaning into a midlife crisis' as part of his creative process. It sounds like a fascinating look into his musical evolution.
ON AIR – What's your favourite Jack Savoretti song, and how do you think his personal life might inspire new music?
MUSIC · NOW

- 4 **Lil Nas X has shared positive news with fans, revealing he's 'feeling better' after a period in rehab and a bipolar diagnosis.**
The 'Old Town Road' star was arrested last year, but it's great to hear he's focusing on his health and recovery. Fans will be wishing him all the best.
ON AIR – It's so important for celebrities to be open about mental health. How do you think their honesty helps others?
MUSIC · NOW

- 5 **Exciting news for history and art lovers: the new London Museum Smithfield site is set to open its doors this November!**
This impressive new home will house incredible exhibits, including Banksy's piranhas and the UK's oldest hand-written document. It's going to be a must-visit.
ON AIR – What's the one museum exhibit you'd love to see, and why do you think museums are so important?
CULTURE · AUTUMN

On the schedule

1 **British tennis star Jack Draper is set to make his return from injury at Eastbourne, with a new coach by his side: Andy Murray!**

This is big news for Draper as he prepares for the grass court season. However, Emma Raducanu has decided not to take a wildcard for the event.

ON AIR – What impact do you think having Andy Murray as a coach will have on Jack Draper's game?

TENNIS · UK

2 **New Zealand's Matt Henry has put himself on the honours board at The Oval, completing a five-wicket haul against England in the second Test.**

His impressive bowling performance has given New Zealand complete control of the match early on day three. England will need to fight hard to recover.

ON AIR – What's been your favourite five-wicket haul you've ever watched in a Test match?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Odds-on favourite Precise powered away to win the Coronation Stakes at Royal Ascot, securing a fantastic victory for trainer Aidan O'Brien.**

It was a thrilling race at one of the most prestigious events in the racing calendar. Precise showed incredible form to take the top spot.

ON AIR – Do you have a favourite memory from Royal Ascot, or a horse that's always stood out to you?

HORSE RACING · UK

4 **Scotland put up a thrilling fight against West Indies at Headingley, but ultimately fell just short in a nail-biting T20 World Cup contest.**

Highlights show a close match where Scotland pushed the West Indies all the way. It was an agonising defeat but a strong performance.

ON AIR – What's the most exciting T20 match you've ever seen, and what made it so memorable?

CRICKET · UK

5 **US golfer Wyndham Clark has taken a commanding four-shot overnight lead at the US Open, thanks to a superb eagle on the 5th hole.**

Clark's impressive play at Shinnecock Hills has put him in a strong position heading into the next day of the tournament. All eyes will be on him.

ON AIR – Who are you backing to win the US Open this year, and what makes them your favourite?

GOLF · INTERNATIONAL

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that taking a 'digital detox' can significantly improve sleep quality and reduce stress.**
Researchers found that even a short break from screens before bed helped participants fall asleep faster and feel more refreshed in the morning.
- 2 The trend for 'slow tourism' is growing, with more people choosing to immerse themselves in local cultures rather than rushing through destinations.**
This mindful approach to travel encourages longer stays and a deeper connection with the places visited, focusing on experiences over checklists.
- 3 Experts are noting a rise in 'intergenerational hobbies', where different age groups come together to share skills and interests.**
From knitting circles to technology workshops, these activities foster unique bonds and a rich exchange of knowledge between generations.
- 4 A study reveals that 'singing in a choir' can boost mood and strengthen social connections.**
The act of singing in harmony with others releases endorphins and creates a strong sense of community, proving beneficial for mental well-being.
- 5 There's a growing interest in 'heritage crafts', as people seek to learn traditional skills like pottery, weaving, and woodworking.**
This revival not only preserves ancient techniques but also offers a mindful and rewarding escape from modern life.
- 6 New research indicates that regularly spending time near 'water features' like rivers or fountains can reduce anxiety.**
The calming sounds and visual appeal of water have a therapeutic effect, helping to lower stress levels and promote relaxation.
- 7 The popularity of 'guerilla gardening' is on the rise, with communities transforming neglected public spaces into green oases.**
This grassroots movement brings neighbours together to beautify their local areas, often using hardy plants to create vibrant displays.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

- Q** Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what to a packet of biscuits before anyone else gets to them?
- ANSWER:** LOOKING FOR THE 'BEST' ONE OR BREAKING OFF A LITTLE PIECE TO 'TEST' IT!

- Q** A recent poll asked Brits what small, everyday 'moment' instantly makes them feel genuinely chuffed with themselves. What came out on top?
- ANSWER:** GETTING ALL THE LAUNDRY FOLDED AND PUT AWAY IN ONE GO, WITHOUT IT SITTING IN A BASKET FOR DAYS!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you hear a 'specific sound' that just instantly brings a smile to your face, or takes you back to a happy memory?**
What's that one sound – whether it's the kettle boiling, birds singing, or a particular musical intro – that always brightens your day?
- **We all have those certain 'little rituals' that we do, often without thinking, that just make our day feel right.**
What's a small, perhaps quirky, ritual you do every day or every week that you wouldn't want to miss?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of pugs is actually called a 'grumble'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The collective noun for a group of owls is a 'parliament', while a group of otters is known as a 'romp'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.46 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.46 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Barrier Reef is the only living thing on Earth visible from space.
- A 'butt' is an actual unit of measurement, often used for wine, equivalent to two hogsheads.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'I am'.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The world's oldest known living tree is over 5,000 years old and is a bristlecone pine in California.
- The inventor of the Pringle can, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- The first successful photograph of a human was taken in 1838, but the person was getting their shoes shined so they were stationary for the long exposure.

On this day

Day 171 of the year, 194 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Adalbert of Magdeburg; Christian feast day: Blessed Dermot O'Hurley; Christian feast day: Florentina; Christian feast day: John of Matera. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1949 — Lionel Richie, American singer, songwriter, pianist, producer, and actor
- 1978 — Quinton Jackson, American mixed martial artist and actor
- 1954 — Michael Anthony, American musician
- 1973 — Chino Moreno, American singer, guitarist and lyricist
- 1941 — Stephen Frears, English actor, director, and producer
- 1956 — Peter Reid, English footballer and manager
- 1939 — Budge Rogers, English rugby player and manager
- 1967 — Dan Tyminski, American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1979 — ABC News correspondent Bill Stewart is shot dead by a Nicaraguan National Guard soldier under the regime of Anastasio Somoza Debayle during the Nicaraguan Revolution. The murder is caught on tape and sparks an international outcry against the regime.
- 1956 — A Venezuelan Super-Constellation crashes in the Atlantic Ocean off Asbury Park, New Jersey, killing 74 people.
- 1973 — Aeroméxico Flight 229 crashes on approach to Licenciado Gustavo Díaz Ordaz International Airport, killing all 27 people on board.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1960 — The Mali Federation gains independence from France (it later splits into Mali and Senegal).
- 1982 — The Argentine Corbeta Uruguay base on Southern Thule surrenders to Royal Marine commandos in the final action of the Falklands War.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1994 — The 1994 Imam Reza shrine bomb explosion in Iran leaves at least 25 dead and 70 to 300 injured.
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1944 — The experimental MW 18014 V-2 rocket reaches an altitude of 176 km, becoming the first man-made object to reach outer space.

- 2019 — Iran's Air Defense Forces shoot down an American surveillance drone over the Strait of Hormuz amid rising tensions between the two countries.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 172 of the year, 193 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alban of Mainz; Christian feast day: Aloysius Gonzaga; Christian feast day: Engelmund of Velsen; Christian feast day: John Rigby. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1947 — Michael Gross, American actor
- 1964 — Doug Savant, American actor
- 1967 — Jim Breuer, American comedian, actor, and producer
- 1940 — Mariette Hartley, American actress and television personality
- 1964 — David Morrissey, English actor and director
- 1959 — Kathy Mattea, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1948 — Ian McEwan, British novelist and screenwriter
- 1950 — Joey Kramer, American rock drummer and songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1973 — The Primer Congreso del Hombre Andino is inaugurated in Arica, Chile.
- 2000 — Section 28 (of the Local Government Act 1988), outlawing the 'promotion' of homosexuality in the United Kingdom, is repealed in Scotland with a 99 to 17 vote.
- 1945 — World War II: The Battle of Okinawa ends when the organized resistance of Imperial Japanese Army forces collapses in the Mabuni area on the southern tip of the main island.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1978 — The original production of Tim Rice and Andrew Lloyd Webber's musical, Evita, based on the life of Eva Perón, opens at the Prince Edward Theatre, London.
- 1989 — The U.S. Supreme Court rules in Texas v. Johnson, 491 U.S. 397, that American flag-burning is a form of political protest protected by the First Amendment.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)